nitrogenous fertilizer (urea). These programmes have no real impact on productivity now.

As the Budget proposals for agriculture made no course correction, they were not expected to make any real difference to stimulating growth.

Expenditure for Promoting Industries and Services Small and Thinly Spread

The Central government undertakes over 100 different programmes to promote industry and service businesses. Over seventy-five of these have a Budget provision exceeding Rs 100 crore for 2020–21. These programmes target a large spectrum of industries and services. The estimated cost works out to approximately Rs 55,000 crore, or 3.2 per cent of the government's total discretionary spend. These outlays did not see any notable increase in 2020–21 over 2019–20.

Most of these programmes focus on some kind of subsidization to small businesses and exporters to reduce cost of debt and incentivize employment. Indian industry faces the triple cost disadvantage of interest, tax and power tariff. Interest rates have to fall in general. Some minor interest cost subsidization is neither efficient nor easily administrable. The tax regime for service enterprises and existing manufacturing industries continues to be disadvantageous; though for new manufacturing it is now comparable to the best. More value added (in excess of 60 per cent) comes from services. There was no proposal to provide power to industries at competitive rates.

There does not appear to be any strategy to fire up the growth engines of the future. Through there are a few programmes to support sunrise sectors like start-ups, these are too few and far between. There is recognition that service enterprises will be the champions of the future and small allocations (mostly a token Rs 5 crore) were made in the budgets of